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Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>

RE: Proposed enhancement to Waterproofing system - 1 Riverside Cottages

1 message

Adam Clutterbuck <ac@hxc.uk> 17 December 2025 at 14:30
To: Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>

You're welcome Nicholas

I will keep fingers crossed for you and Louisa and look forward to hearing good news.

Kind regards

Adam

Adam Clutterbuck

Home & Commercial

E: ac@hxc.uk

T: 01722 714455 (direct line)

M: 07904 093727

From: Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>
Sent: 17 December 2025 12:58
To: Adam Clutterbuck <ac@hxc.uk>
Subject: Re: Proposed enhancement to Waterproofing system - 1 Riverside Cottages

Thanks, Adam.

I am following your suggestion that we do not link the internal and external pumps. Aside from the backflow risk—which I completely agree with—Maclennans have now confirmed that they also do not want all of the pressure placed onto a single set of pumps. They are therefore in agreement that the chambers should remain separate.

I am pleased that you agree the external pumps are a worthwhile measure to help reduce flooding at the rear of the property.

Thank you very much for all your help, Adam. It is greatly appreciated.

Kind regards,
Nicholas

Nicholas Scarr

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On Mon, 15 Dec 2025 at 23:21, Adam Clutterbuck <ac@hxc.uk> wrote:

> Hi Nicholas,
>
> Sorry, just found this note in my drafts folder!
>
> Just back from funeral.
>
> Thanks for your note; I agree that an external
>
> pump is a worthwhile measure to reduce risk
>
> of flooding to the rear. You may want to consider the planks across the door openings too; this would then deal with the front entrance (3 door openings in total?)
>
> Bw
>
> Adam
>
> ---
>
> **From:** Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>
> **Sent:** 12 December 2025 3:40 PM
> **To:** Adam Clutterbuck <ac@hxc.uk>
> **Subject:** Re: Proposed enhancement to Waterproofing system - 1 Riverside Cottages
>
> Dear Adam,
>
> Many thanks for your email. I have taken on board your comments.
>
> You are quite right that any linkage between the internal and external chambers needs to be very carefully considered, particularly in relation to backflow risk and reliance on non-return valves.
>
> The reason I remain minded to include the external chamber is that MacLennan are clear that, in a flood or surcharge scenario, water needs to be pumped away above the flood line. There is a concern that if the drains

themselves are overwhelmed, discharging into them may not be effective, as was the case during the last incident, where sewage accumulated across the rear passage to the level of the second step.

We do not have flood protection doors at the rear of the property, and installing them would be both disruptive and expensive. From my perspective, the external chamber addresses several issues in one solution: it allows water to be moved away from the rear elevation and up the garden above the flood line, reduces reliance on potentially surcharged drains, and mitigates the need for flood doors at the rear. We have also experienced significant water accumulation on the rear patio on a number of occasions, quite apart from the sewage incident, which reinforces my view that actively managing water in that area is important.

For those reasons, and based on MacLennan's advice that they consider the external chamber to be a **key component of the system**, I intend to pursue this with insurers.

Thank you also for raising the point regarding fees. If you could let me have a note of any additional fees arising from this exchange in due course, I will seek to put these through insurers via Andy Lyne. You're quite right that for any more substantive future input, it would be sensible to seek insurer approval in advance.

Kind regards,
Nicholas

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On Fri, 12 Dec 2025 at 07:15, Adam Clutterbuck <ac@hxc.uk> wrote:

> Good morning, Nicholas
>
> Apologies for the delay; a few thoughts:

- The initial works to be undertaken by MacLennan is the application of a Cementitious waterproofing barrier (£16,367); this should provide a first line of defence as a form of barrier protection. If any water gets past this it should only be minor seepage (suggest check with Simon as to exactly what their Cemcoat system is so you have a reasonable understanding).
- The risk of sewage entering the interior (through the Cemcoat) is therefore unlikely.
- You refer to the internal chamber discharging onto the paths; this should not be what MacLennan have in mind as their discharge pipes (I suggest one for each pump in the internal chamber) will discharge any water from the sump out to a drain and have non-return valves (NRV)on each pump to prevent any possible surcharge.
- The pump system will be sealed and self-contained, the suggestion of linking to the outside chamber with an overflow is not a usual measure and I would be concerned with the risk of backflow/surcharge from the external chamber back into the internal, although a NRV can be fitted of course.
- NRVs are not ideal as they need to be kept maintained and can stick open or closed.
- Of course, sump pumps and battery back up for the internal GW system are essential; that's how the system works and is sure of working (for a time) during a power outage (if any water gets through the Cemcoat system).

I hope this helps, and in summary I recommend that you obtain full details of exactly what the Cemcoat system consists of; some photos of a typical installation will be helpful for you to see what kind of barrier will be installed. If you can ask Maclennan for data sheets (with images) for all of their proposals that should be helpful for you and your contractor.

The associated works required from the main contractor before and after the MacLennan works need to be listed, detailed, and priced by your contractor. A meeting with both contractors presents on site to go over everything in detail will be necessary; this may not be Simon, but a contracts/project manager from MacLennan who may want some variations, so worth arranging in good time to get a good understanding of all aspects and costs to put to Garrett Young.

You may also want to check with Garrett that insurers will pay for any additional technical input from me (at my hourly rate and terms) after the submission of my report and initial invoice. This is not an issue when I am appointed by the insurers/adjuster as they are the ones coming back to me, but in your case, you may be asked to settle any additional professional costs unless agreed with them. Sorry to mention.

Hope this helps.

Kind regards

Adam

Adam Clutterbuck

A picture containing brass knucks, scissors Description automatically generated

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From: Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>
Sent: 10 December 2025 16:32
To: Adam Clutterbuck <ac@hxc.uk>
Subject: Proposed enhancement to Waterproofing system

Dear Adam,

Following our conversation this morning, I wanted to clarify and expand on a point that only came to my attention yesterday. I had assumed that the external sump pumps were sewage-capable, in the same way that the internal pumps are. Having looked into this more closely, I discovered that the external pumps are **not** designed to handle sewage, which presents a clear vulnerability given the nature of the previous incident.

Having researched this further, I believe it is very important that we do everything possible to **mitigate the risk of sewage entering the gravity drain system**. With that in mind, I think it would be sensible to incorporate an **overflow route from the sewer manhole into the external sump chamber**, so that in the event of a surcharge or pump failure, any overflow is directed into the chamber rather than towards the house.

It also seems logical, rather than allowing the internal chamber to discharge onto the paths, that we instead **route that discharge into the external sump chamber**, enabling the system to pump contamination a further **40–50 metres up the garden and away from the property**. This would give us a far safer and more controlled means of handling any repeat contamination.

I have discussed these changes with **Simon Riches at MacLennan**, who agrees that they represent an important and necessary enhancement to the overall design. He has also confirmed that the **sump pumps and the battery back-up system** are, in his view, **essential elements of the waterproofing and protection strategy**.

These changes will of course add to the overall cost, but I believe we can do quite a lot to ensure that the uplift is **not material**. I will be asking both MacLennan and Silks to keep any additional costs to an absolute minimum, as I am very keen to get this agreed and over the line with the insurers.

I reread your report yesterday and was very mindful of the points you made about the **pumping station being above the property**, and the way water and sewage naturally **flow downhill into the walled rear area**. Having reviewed the video footage again, it is clear to me that the enhancements I am proposing would make a great deal of sense in light of the risks you identified.

I hope and trust that you agree this approach is both **sensible and proportionate**, given the previous sewage flooding and the particular vulnerability of the rear of the property. I would be very grateful for any comments or additional suggestions you may have.

Many thanks, Adam.

Kind regards,
Nicholas

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